

Hardware strategy

We do not make hardware, hold stock, or warrant anyone else's. This note sets out what that buys, what it costs us, and what we are honestly accepting in exchange.

The cost comparison, stated so it survives being checked

Approach	Components	Cost	Note
Dedicated terminal (the incumbent model)	Android/Windows POS terminal	₹52,990 – 92,190	The stack WeP quotes for a serious counter
	Billing printer	₹15,490 – 25,190	
	Barcode scanner	~₹4,500	
Total dedicated stack		₹70,000 – 1,20,000+	
Entry billing machine ← the honest denominator	WeP BP Joy Pro	₹9,990	This is what a single-counter shop is actually offered, and what our comparison must beat
	WeP BP Joy Plus / BP 2000	₹11,999 – 13,500	
	WeP BP 2100	₹25,500	
Bolo Bill	Android phone — usually already owned	₹0 (or ₹10–15k)	Camera does the scanning; no scanner to buy
	Bluetooth thermal printer	₹2,500 – 6,000	
	Barcode scanning (software)	₹0	
Total incremental spend		₹0 – 6,000	₹0 where a printer already exists

Use the second comparison, not the first. Against the ₹70k–1.2L terminal stack the saving is 92–100% and sounds too good to be true — because for a one-counter shop it is: nobody was selling them that. Against the ₹9,990 billing machine the saving is **40–100%**, and it is unarguable. The weaker-sounding number is the stronger claim, because it is the one that holds when an investor opens wepmyshop.com in the meeting.

What we are accepting in exchange — and what we do about it

Trade-off	The honest problem	Mitigation
Durability	A consumer phone at a counter meets flour, oil, wet hands and a two-foot drop onto a stone floor. A purpose-built terminal is sealed and expects this.	A ₹300 splash case in the curated kit. Beyond that we accept it: the phone is replaceable and the data is not on it. This is a genuine advantage of a device-agnostic design — a broken phone costs a phone, not a POS.
Battery under load	Continuous mic plus screen-on billing through a lunch rush will flatten a mid-range phone in a few hours. On-device ASR increases this, not reduces it.	A ₹200 counter charging stand in the kit and a documented expectation that the phone is on charge while billing. VALIDATE real drain per hour — measurable, and not yet measured.
BYOD and shared phones	The counter phone may be the owner's personal one. Staff billing on the owner's phone is awkward; staff billing on their own phone raises who-sees-what.	Staff accounts with their own passcodes exist already, and staff cannot see or change prices. The unsolved part is a shop whose only phone leaves when the owner does — for those, the

		₹10–15k second phone is a real cost and should be quoted as such rather than hidden.
No single warranty	WeP sells one box with one number to call. We sell software and point at a printer somebody else made. When the printer fails, the shopkeeper's first call is to us.	The hardest trade-off and the one most likely to cost us in support. Curate <i>one</i> printer model we have tested, resold at near cost, so support answers one set of questions rather than fifty. Accept the support load as a real line in the cost model rather than assuming it away.
Thermal print under sustained load	A ₹2,500 printer is not specified for hundreds of receipts a day; print heads fade and paper feeds jam.	Honest tiering: the cheap printer suits Tier 1 volumes. Growing and Chain tiers should be quoted a ₹6,000+ unit. Not a problem to solve, a specification to state.
Bluetooth Classic	Most cheap ESC/POS printers speak Bluetooth Classic over SPP, which a browser cannot open at any price. The PoC can only reach BLE printers.	Solved by the Android app, not by more browser work — a few lines against BluetoothSocket. Until then, printing goes through Android's own print service. This is a concrete reason the app is Phase 1, not a nice-to-have.

The kit — curated, not manufactured

One tested printer, a roll of paper, a splash case and a charging stand, sold as a "shop kit" at or near cost — around **₹3,500–4,500** **VALIDATE**. It is an adoption lever and a support-cost control, not a revenue line. The moment it becomes a margin line we start carrying inventory, and carrying inventory is the thing this whole strategy exists to avoid.

What we will not do: manufacture, hold stock, or private-label. A hardware business has different economics, different capital needs and a different investor. Saying so plainly in the deck is a feature — it is what makes a solo founder's capital efficiency credible rather than optimistic.

Why this is strategically load-bearing, not just cheap

The capex delta is the reason a shop can **try** us. A ₹9,990 machine is a decision that needs a spouse consulted and a week's thought; a free app on the phone in your hand is a decision made during a quiet hour. That difference is the entire top of our funnel, and it is why the pricing model must treat hardware capex as a customer-acquisition variable rather than a footnote.

It is also the reason we can lose gracefully. A shop that stops paying keeps its phone and its printer and has lost nothing — which makes trying us nearly free, and that asymmetry is worth more at this stage than the switching cost we would gain by locking them into a box.